

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Upper Elementary | Unit 2

Drop the final e


Today I am learning when to **drop the final e** before adding a suffix.

1 Learn the Rule

When a base word ends in a **silent e**, we often drop the **e** before adding a suffix that begins with a vowel.

make + ing = making **hope + ing** = hoping
bake + er = baker **safe + est** = safest

2 Build the Word

Drop the final **e**, add the suffix, and build the new word.

Base word	Add suffix	New word	What changed?
make	-ing	_____	_____
hope	-ing	_____	_____
use	-ing	_____	_____
bake	-er	_____	_____
safe	-est	_____	_____

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

Lena was **making** a poster for the community fair while her brother was **baking** muffins for their stall. She was **hoping** the poster would be easy to read, so she was **using** bright headings and **writing** the details carefully. Soon they were **racing** against the clock because visitors were **arriving**. Lena kept **smiling** while she checked each sign. She moved the drinks to a **safer** place and helped her brother become the busiest **baker** at the fair. After **baking** the last tray, he began **serving** customers while Lena was **taking** notes about which flavours sold fastest. By lunchtime, they were **waving** to friends and laughing about the busy morning. The work had been **tiring**, but **making** everything together had been worth the effort.


Find and highlight words where the final **e** was dropped.

4 Word Detective

Choose one changed word from the passage and investigate how it was built.

- Write one changed word from the passage.

- What is its base word?

- Which suffix was added?

- Show the word sum: base + suffix -> new word.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words into the correct group.

making hoping using jumping reading helping

Base ended in e

Base did not end in e

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- I was _____ when _____.
- Use another **changed word** in a sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Finds the base word ending in **e**
- ☐ Drops final **e** before a vowel suffix
- ☐ Reads changed words accurately
- ☐ Explains the spelling change



Capture idea:

Find an **-ing** word in a book. Work back to the base: did a final **e** disappear?